

Hingham Housing Authority Meeting AMENDED Minutes of Special Meeting

Location: 30 Thaxter Street
Community Room
Date: July 9, 2019
Time: 7:00pm
Attendees: Chairperson Greg O'Meara, Commissioner Janine Suchecki, Commissioner Jim Watson, Commissioner Megan Buhr, Sharon Napier, Executive Director, Colleen Whalen, Assistant Director, Kevin Kazlauskas, Maintenance Supervisor
Absent: Commissioner Irma Lauter

The Special Meeting was called to order by the Chair at 7:03 pm.

Ms. Suchecki read and motioned for the following bylaw amendment change, Hingham Housing Authority to conduct a regular meeting pursuant to the normal agenda and By-Laws Adopted October 3, 1967, Amended March 15, 2017, to further amend Article III Section 3 as required by the By-Laws Article V, "Amendments", as follows:

Regular meetings of the Authority shall be held monthly for the transaction of business of the Authority. The Board may vote to have an additional regular meeting at the previous regular meeting.

Residents Sherry Smith and Beth James requested clarification of bylaw changes.

Commissioners assured residents that the change would allow them to hold more regular meetings if necessary.

Commissioner Watson seconded. Motion to accept and approve bylaw change unanimous, 4-0.

June 11, 2019 meeting minutes read and reviewed, Commissioner Suchecki made motion to amend, and Commissioner Buhr made motion to further amend. Commissioner Buhr moved to accept seconded. Vote 3-1 to accept, Commissioner Suchecki abstained.

Report from Resident's Association - Beth James, President, reported there had not been a meeting since last month, therefore no report.

Director's report:

Ms. Napier handed out packet of policies and various documents to Ms. Suchecki as the newest board member and a copy to Chair O' Meara with comments that same had been emailed.

Ms. Napier requested that review and consideration of the Annual May 14, 2019 meeting minutes be reviewed and voted. Discussion regarding Ms. Buhr arriving late and that the agenda had been changed. Discussion ensued regarding times for items on agendas.

Ms. Buhr moved to amend minutes to include her as present, Commissioner Suchecki seconded to accept change. Minutes deferred to next meeting.

1. Vacancy Report-we had 1 vacancy during the month of June 2019
2. Financial warrants-accounts payable distribution for May 2019 :
Totals: Section 8 Housing Assistance Payments (HAP) \$30,983; Management Accts payable, \$35,493.15
June 2019: S8: \$30,056, Management accounts payable, \$52,337.59
3. Accountant's report for May 2019: -looking at the bottom lines for the accounts, favorable cumulative for 11 months \$34,195. We are at healthy operating reserves of 54.25% for Thaxter Park. We show losses for the Section 8 program due to program administrative changes. We had unexpected non-routine expenses for Beal Street.
4. Capital expenditures- Strekalovsky-final payments: walkways \$2700 and windows \$405
5. General update on properties- See Maintenance and report attached.
6. Our next regularly scheduled meeting is August 13, 2019 @ 7pm.

Maintenance report given by Kevin Kazlauskas-general update on properties.

Discussion regarding procurement process.

Report of committees-there are none

Report of old business-Mr. Watson requested discussion of Amy Stitely's letter dated June 26th. Chair O'Meara updated, verifying that a joint meeting was in the process of being scheduled via Ms. Napier to discuss the land issues.

Beth James, resident commented if residents could be notified of meeting. Chair O'Meara verified it would probably be an open meeting for negotiation and settlement.

Danielle Freida, resident, questioned why selectmen are involved in land deal. Chair O'Meara reiterated that an agreement had been made 18 years ago.

Jeanie Haviland, resident, asked what town wants to do with land. Chair O'Meara stated that it would be decided by town.

Discussion ensued regarding original purpose of Beal Street land. Suchecki clarified Quitclaim deed re: Beal Street. Attempt of vote was under parameters of checks and balances of law. Her understanding of law was that land was voted in 2001 to be transferred to town.

Joe Fisher, 3 Huckleberry Hill Lane, Hingham, selectman, introduced himself as housing liaison moving forward and glad to answer any questions or concerns and looking forward to working with us. He will be at coffee hour with Director on Thursday 7/11 @ 10:00 AM, 30 Thaxter Street, community room.

Pat O'Loughlin, resident, wanted verification none of the 8 acres were at Thaxter Park. Chair O'Meara confirmed it was not.

Judi Maglio, resident, asked why town wants land, Chair O'Meara stated they took buildings away 18 years ago and there was an agreement to give land back to town.

Stephanie Strikiatis, resident, questioned how much did the town pay to have the buildings removed. Commissioner Suchecki stated it is in a document housed with the Board of Selectman with the exact dollar amount. Chair O'Meara reiterated that the issue is with the Board of Selectman now.

Beth James, resident, clarified that Director has no vote, Hingham Housing Authority "board" does not include the Director. Director does not vote.

Chair O'Meara handed to Ms. Napier, noting such, original motion, copy of Quitclaim deed, and minutes of meeting along with transmittal letter that went to selectmen re: 100 Beal Street, Hingham, 8.02 acre parcel Division of School Tract II.

New business-none

Chair O'Meara asked for motion to adjourn regular meeting and to go into executive session to review and respond to Open meeting Law Complaint pursuant to MGL c. 30A, Sec 21(a)(1) filed by Sharon Napier. Mr. Watson made motion to close regular meeting and move to executive session with no further opening of regular session. Commissioner Buhr seconded. Vote unanimous 4-0.

Regular meeting adjourned at 8:03 pm.

Respectfully submitted,

Sharon Napier

Executive Director